duolingo PRESENTS

ASSIGNMENT 9 · PROTOTYPE

Duo Tarot

a tarot reading that ends in a first lesson

the owl sees all. including your streak.

Cindy Ha · AI in Marketing · November 2026

try the reader here



A · THE BRIEF

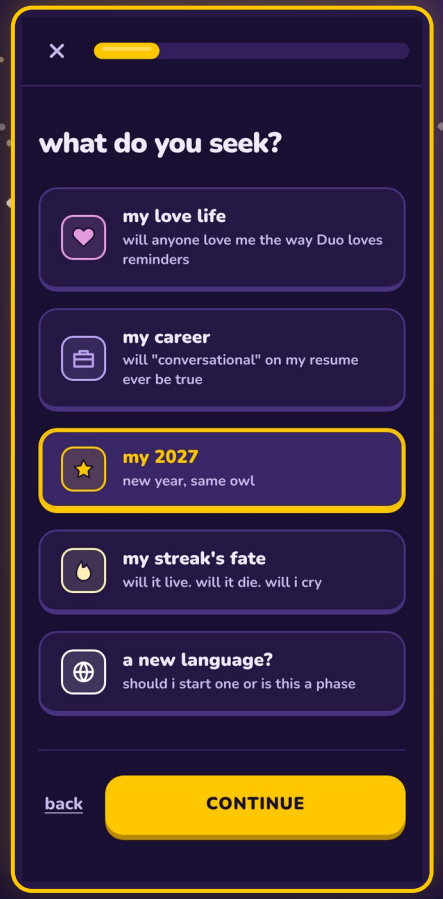
Built to turn a friend’s share into a first lesson



Job	Turn Instagram and TikTok traffic into new learners with a reading worth sharing.
Audience	18 to 34 social users who know the streak memes, often lapsed, arriving from a friend’s share card.
Conversion goal	**Tap “fulfill your prophecy” to start a first lesson.** measured: first lesson in 24 h

A campaign page that opens into a tarot reader





1

Arrive

from a friend's share card or a bio link

2

Open the reader

one "pull a card" button

3

Answer 5 taps

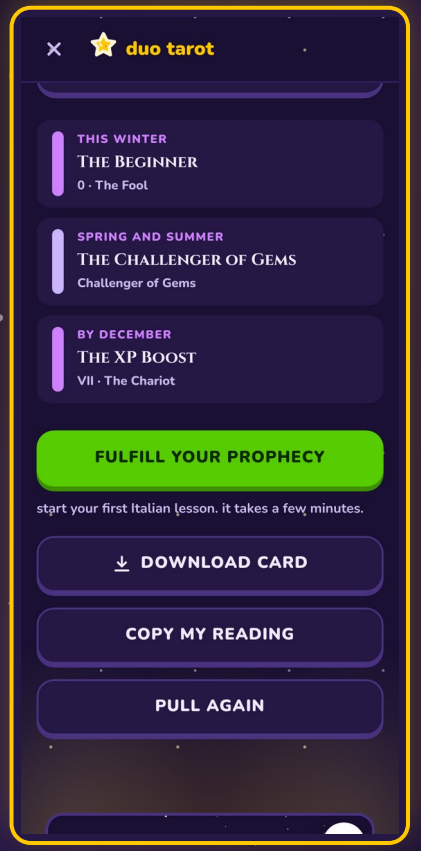
name, what you seek, streak, language, tone

try the reader here

Five taps, three cards, one prophecy, one green button



4 · Flip 3 cards



5 · Tap “fulfill your prophecy”



6 · Download the share card

No two readings match

- **Your streak** picks the cards
- **Your tone** picks the voice
- **Your language** becomes the prophecy

try the reader here

Claude for the thinking, Claude Code for the build

WHILE THE IDEA WAS MOVING

Claude

Ideas · Copy · Mockups · Prototype

Right while the idea was moving: six concepts, two mockups and a clickable prototype, fast enough to throw away what didn't work.

ONCE THE IDEA WAS FIXED

Claude Code

204 automated tests

Right once the idea was fixed: a real project with tests, so every change could be checked against a 71-item QA list.

try the reader here

Zuzu set the rules; a tarot night sky needed a few new ones



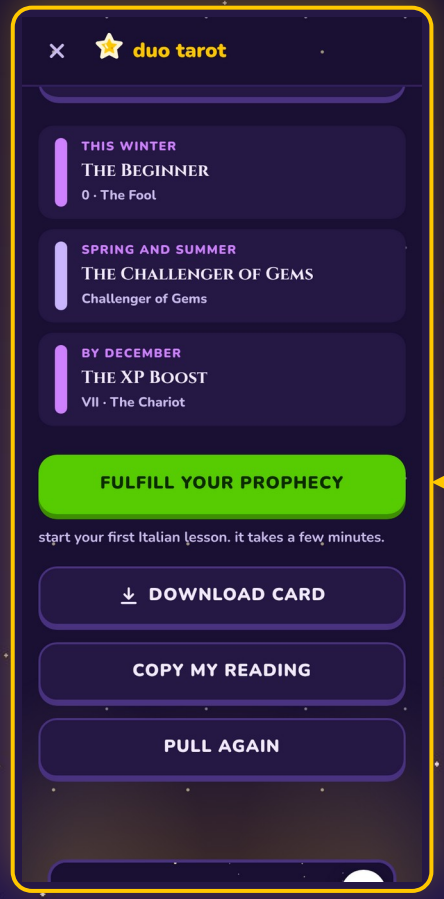
Kept from Zuzu

- Nunito type and the Duolingo voice rules
- Sunny gold accents, always with ink text
- Rounded corners and ledge shadows on buttons
- Leaf green means go: only the lesson button
- Never shame the learner

Extended for the medium

- Night purple leads instead of Leaf green
- Cinzel for card numerals, a tarot convention
- Glow, holo tilt and a star cursor

One action per screen, and nothing to sign up for



the only green

It appears the moment the prophecy names your language, so the reward and the next step land together.

LEFT OUT

Sign-up form, email capture, navigation

REMOVED

~~Birds, rainbow suits, 2 extra buttons~~



SHARE CARD ASKS

“what do the cards say about you?”

HERO ANSWERS

“the owl sees all.”

try the reader here

People read it as tarot instantly, and as Duolingo only later

FIVE-SECOND TEST · HIS ANSWERS

What is it?

A tarot reading. He knew right away, from the layout.

Who is it for?

Duolingo users, but only once the streak and language questions appeared.

What did it want you to do?

Give quick info (name, streak, subject) to get a tarot reading.

CONVERSION CHECK	RESULT
One goal above the fold the learner chart pushed the button down	Fix needed
Message match	Pass
Works on an actual phone	Pass
Form asks the minimum	Pass
Loads fast	Partial
Keyboard-navigable	Pass

try the reader here

D · TESTED · ONE DOCUMENTED ITERATION

Adding birds made it Halloween, not Duolingo

CHANGE

Flying birds, an owl mark, full Duolingo colors

EXPECTED

Instant brand recognition

ACTUAL

Birds read as bats. Colors clashed. Halloween.



THE FIX

- Star mark
- Soft purple and yellow
- Green only on the lesson button

A B C D E appx

09 / 11 · tested

try the reader here

What's real, what's fake, and what an engineer still has to build

Data — Fake

Today: Nothing is stored or sent; the button opens duolingo.com

Needs: an event pipeline and course deep links

Personal info — Safe

Today: An optional first name that never leaves the browser

Needs: a privacy policy, consent banner, under-18 review

Load and abuse — Safe

Today: Static files, no server to attack; names stripped of code

Needs: a CDN and a profanity filter for share cards

Accessibility — Partial

Today: Keyboard and contrast pass automated checks

Needs: real VoiceOver and TalkBack testing

Integrations — Missing

Today: No CRM, email or payment, by design

Needs: analytics, install attribution, A/B testing

Maintenance — Ready

Today: Copy in 3 plain data files, 204 tests, written notes

Needs: a named owner for copy and code

try the reader here

THE ASK

Launch as “your 2027 reading” after a short hardening sprint

1. **Approve hosting, deep links, analytics**
   turn the stub into a measured funnel
2. **Clear brand review**
   official assets, 13+ copy check
3. **Test on real traffic**
   0-day streaks are the key read



try it live

scan, or open:

ha-cindy.github.io/duo-tarot

APPENDIX A · IDEAS WE EXPLORED

Six ideas, two mockups, one winner

Duo Tarot

chosen

Streak-weighted readings that end in a first lesson

Lingo Match

runner-up

Swipe on languages like a dating app. Reached wider, but looked like Hinge and like Duolingo lessons

Which Character Are You?

Personality quiz. The most proven share format, and the most expected

School Didn't Teach This

Useful-but-unserious phrase cards to send to friends

Thanksgiving Phrasebook

Escape phrases for awkward family dinners. Short shelf life

Get Guilt-Tripped by Duo

Personalized reminder memes. Re-engagement only, not acquisition

APPENDIX B · THE LEARNER'S ARCANA

78 tarot cards, rewritten for learners



Flames

Wands: your drive and your streak

Hearts

Cups: your feelings

Bolts

Swords: your brain, XP and rivalries

Gems

Pentacles: your rewards and effort

How a reading works, and how we checked it

Five inputs, one weighted draw

Name · What you seek · Streak · Language · Gentle or roast

- 0-day users are 5x more likely to pull The Broken Streak
- Year-plus users are 8x more likely to pull The Streak Society
- No duplicates; a hopeful card always lands last
- About 1 in 20 readings is a rare gold pull
- Prophecy: a language, a deadline and a learner chart

98	unit tests
106	browser tests
40 / 52	in-scope QA checks
600	combinations tested

What we'd measure with real traffic

North star	first lesson within 24 h of a reading
Funnel	open rate, quiz drop-off, completion
Virality	share card saves, copies, visits from shares
Key segment	0-day streak users vs. everyone else

try the reader here

SOURCES AND CREDITS

Sources

Assignment brief

Rutgers Business School, AI in Marketing, Assignment 9: Build a Working Prototype

Tarot meanings

Labyrinthos, Tarot Card Meanings List: labyrinthos.co/blogs/tarot-card-meanings-list

Brand voice

Duolingo copywriter skill, built from Duolingo blog posts and Duolingo's posts on X

Product features

Streaks, streak freeze, leagues, hearts, gems, XP and friends quests: duolingo.com

Logo

Duolingo wordmark, used with the professor's permission for class only

Design system

Zuzu Design System (Week 4), built in Claude Design

Fonts

Baloo 2, Nunito and Cinzel from Google Fonts (fonts.google.com)

Test records

Duo Tarot QA report and Claude Code session summary, November 7, 2026

Five-second test

One tester, November 7, 2026

Tools

Claude (ideas, copy, mockups), Claude Code (build, tests), Claude Design (deck draft)

Prototype

ha-cindy.github.io/duo-tarot, hosted on GitHub Pages